

Message 1

The Introductory Word and Jehovah's Reproof on Israel

Scripture Reading: Micah 1:1-16; 2:1-11; 3:1-12

The Minor Prophets reveal that God uses the Gentiles as a means, an instrument, to chastise His elect, Israel. The Gentiles, however, do things in excess, and this offends God, who then comes in to punish the Gentiles. God's chastisement of Israel and His punishment of the Gentiles issue in the manifestation of Christ, and the manifestation of Christ brings in the restoration, which will consummate in the new heaven and new earth. All the Minor Prophets have this same basic thought, although they use different expressions to convey it. In Micah the expressions are very poetic. The entire book of Micah is a book of poetry.

In this message we will begin to consider the prophecy of Micah, covering the introductory word and Jehovah's reproof on Israel.

I. The introductory word

The introductory word is in 1:1.

A. The meaning of the name Micah

Micah is a shortened form of Micaiah, meaning "Who is like Jah?" "Jah" is a shortened form of Jehovah. The longer form of the prophet's name is found in the Hebrew text of Jeremiah 26:18.

B. The time of Micah's ministry

The time of Micah's ministry was about 750-710 B.C., at the time of Isaiah and Hosea.

C. The place of his ministry

The place of his ministry was Judah.

D. The object of his ministry

The object of his ministry was the northern kingdom of Israel (also Judah). In the Old Testament, the term Israel is used for two matters: the whole race of Israel and the northern kingdom of Israel. Because the term is used in these two ways, it is sometimes difficult for us as readers to know whether it refers to the northern kingdom of Israel or to the entire people of Israel. Here it refers to the whole race of Israel, including Judah.

E. The subject

The subject of Micah is Jehovah's reproof on Israel and His restoration of Israel.

F. The central thought

The central thought of Micah is that Jehovah reproofed Israel of her evils and promised her His saving and gathering of her remnant for the restoration (Matt. 19:28) in the millennium (Rev. 20:4, 6).

G. The revelation concerning Christ

In Micah the revelation concerning Christ is very strong. Christ is revealed in His eternal origin (5:2c); in His human birth in Bethlehem (5:2a); in His being the Ruler, the Shepherd, and the peace of Israel in the millennium (Rev. 20:4, 6; Micah 5:2b, 4a, 5a); in His becoming great (5:4b); and in His saving Israel from Assyria (5:6b).

Micah 5:4b says that in the millennium Christ will be great unto the ends of the earth. Daniel 2:34 and 35 tell us that Christ as a stone cut out without hands will crush the great human image and will then become a great mountain, the kingdom of God, and fill the whole earth. Today, apparently Jesus is very small, but in the coming kingdom He will become great.

H. The sections

The book of Micah has five sections: the introductory word (1:1); Jehovah's reproof on Israel (1:2—2:11; 3:1-12); Jehovah's comfort to Israel (2:12-13; 4:1—5:15); Jehovah's contention with Israel (6:1-16); and the prophet's observation and expectation (7:1-20).

II. Jehovah's reproof on Israel

Let us now consider Jehovah's reproof on Israel.

A. Jehovah's coming in judgment from His holy temple

In verse 2 the prophet tells the peoples to hear and the earth to give heed and let the Lord Jehovah be a witness against them, the Lord from His holy temple. Then, indicating that Jehovah is coming in judgment from His holy temple, the prophet continues, "For behold, Jehovah comes forth from His place, / And He will come down and tread upon the high places of the earth. / And the mountains will be melted under Him, / And the valleys will be cleft, / Like wax before fire, / Like water poured down a slope" (vv. 3-4).

B. The cause

The cause of Jehovah's reproof on Israel is found in verse 5. Here the prophet says, "All this is because of the transgression of Jacob / And because of the sins of the house of Israel. / What is the transgression of Jacob? / Is it not Samaria? / And what are the high places of Judah? / Are they not Jerusalem?"

C. The destruction of Samaria

According to verse 6, Samaria will be made a heap of ruins in a field, places for the planting of vineyards. Verse 7 goes on to say, "All her engraved idols will be smashed, / And all her gifts for harlotry will be burned with fire, / And all her images I will make a desolation; / For from the harlot's hire she has gathered them, / And unto the harlot's hire they will return."

D. The invasion of Jerusalem

Verses 8 and 9 are concerned with the invasion of Jerusalem. Here the prophet declares, "Because of this I will wail and howl; / I will go about barefoot and naked. / I will make a wailing like the jackals / And a lamentation like the ostriches. / For her wounds are incurable, / For it has come as far as Judah; / It reaches as far as the gate of my people, / As far as Jerusalem."

E. The terrors in Judah and Israel and the evils from Jehovah

In the remainder of chapter one (vv. 10-16), we have an account of the terrors in Judah and Israel and the evils from Jehovah.

F. Jehovah's reproof on Israel's evils

Micah 2:1-11 is a record of Jehovah's reproof on Israel's evils.

G. Jehovah's reproof on the heads and rulers of the house of Israel

Micah 3:1-11 describes Jehovah's reproof on the heads and rulers of the house of Israel.

H. The destruction of Jerusalem and Mount Zion

Finally, verse 12 speaks regarding the destruction of Jerusalem and Mount Zion. "Therefore on account of you / Zion will be plowed as a field, / And Jerusalem will be heaps, / And the mountain of the house will become the high places of a forest."

All the Minor Prophets touched the same thing — God's chastisement over Israel and His punishment on the nations issuing in the manifestation of Christ for the restoration of the whole universe, consummating in the new heaven and new earth. This shows that in the consideration of the godly people, mainly the prophets, there was the expectation that the Messiah would come to restore not only the kingdom of Israel but also the entire universe, especially the sun, the moon, and the stars, for the growing of the living things on the earth, that the earth might be very rich in produce. Isaiah 30:26 says that in the restoration "the light of the sun will be sevenfold," not for scorching but for shining, for giving sunshine to grow the living things on earth. This means that the heavens will answer the earth and cause it to grow things in a rich way (Hosea 2:21-22). The sun's shining seven times brighter indicates that the produce of the earth will be seven times richer than it is today. At that time there will be no scarcity but rather plenitude.

Before Adam fell, the earth was rich in produce. Man did not need to labor with sweating. However, after man fell, God came in to curse the earth and to tell man that he would eat of the earth by the sweat of his brow (Gen. 3:17-19). But in the age of restoration, "the mountains will drop down fresh wine, / And the hills will flow with milk" (Joel 3:18). Since there will be no poverty or scarcity, there will be no need for the various "isms," such as communism and capitalism, to exist in order to balance the social wealth. Like the birds (Matt. 6:25-26), the people on earth will partake of all the natural resources of the earth in a common way. In the restoration there will be no merchants (Zech. 14:21b, where "Canaanite" may also be translated "merchant"), no money (mammon, Luke 16:9), no buying and selling, no police stations, and no law courts. Christ will be there as the source of the rich supply, as the inner law of life, and as everything for us to enjoy.

Jehovah's Comfort to Israel

Scripture Reading: Micah 2:12-13; 4:1-13; 5:1-15

We have emphasized the fact that all the minor prophets speak the same thing in different ways, from different angles, and in different aspects. Thus, Micah also speaks the same thing as the other minor prophets, but he speaks it in his own particular way.

In the foregoing message we covered the introductory word and Jehovah's reproof on Israel. Micah 1 reveals that Jehovah is coming forth out of His temple to exercise His judgment upon sinful Israel. Verses 3 and 4 portray the terrible judgment that is coming. "Jehovah comes forth from His place, / And He will come down and tread upon the high places of the earth. / And the mountains will be melted under Him, / And the valleys will be cleft, / Like wax before fire, / Like water poured down a slope." Because of this judgment, the prophet wailed and howled, and some of the people also wailed (vv. 9-16). The next two chapters, part of Jehovah's reproof, are a description of the sinfulness of the house of Jacob and the house of Judah.

In this message we will consider Jehovah's comfort to Israel. This comfort is actually a matter of restoration.

III. Jehovah's comfort to Israel

Jehovah's comfort to Israel is found in 2:12-13 and 4:1—5:15.

A. The restoration of Israel in the millennium

Micah 4:1-5 concerns the restoration of Israel (Matt. 19:28) in the millennium (Rev. 20:4, 6; Isa. 2:2-5). At that time the people will no longer learn war (Micah 4:3), but, enjoying life without disturbance, "they will each sit underneath his vine / And underneath his fig tree, / And no one will disturb them" (v. 4). Each one will eat and drink for his enjoyment in peace. This eating and drinking will be a kind of worship to God.

The thousand years of the millennium will be a continual feast. According to the Old Testament, during the yearly feasts the children of Israel were charged not to work (Lev. 23:7, 8, 35). To work during those feasts would have been an insult to God. The people were only to rest, eat, drink, and enjoy their life before God. Their eating and drinking were their worship to God. According to the New Testament, at the Lord's table on the first day of the week, we put aside our work, we rest in the Lord, and we eat and drink Christ to enjoy Him and to let Him enjoy our satisfaction. This is the top worship to God, and this is the Christian life — a restful life for worship. God is seeking such worshippers (John 4:23-24). We have been called not to work and to labor but to worship. Every day and every night we should worship God by enjoying Him.

B. Jehovah's gathering of the remnant of the people

In His comfort to Israel Jehovah will gather the remnant of the people (2:12-13; 4:6-8). In 2:12 Jehovah promises to gather all of Jacob and assemble the remnant of Israel. In 4:6 and 7 He says that He will gather her that limps and collect her that has been driven out and her that He has afflicted, and He will make her that limps a remnant and her that has been cast far away, a mighty nation.

C. Israel to be captured and Jehovah's deliverance to Israel

Jehovah's comfort to Israel also includes His deliverance to Israel after Israel is captured (4:9-13; 5:1). This means that God will meet every need and solve every problem.

D. Christ to come as Israel's Ruler, Shepherd, and peace

Micah 5:2 is a prophecy concerning Christ. This verse says that His "goings forth are from ancient times, / From the days of eternity." His "goings forth" are His coming out. To the angels it is His going forth, but to us it is His coming out.

"His goings forth are...from the days of eternity" means that in eternity, before the creation of the earth, Christ was preparing to come forth. His appearing, His manifestation, began in eternity. From the ancient times, from the days of eternity, the Triune God was preparing to come forth out of eternity into time, to come with His divinity into humanity. His creation of all things was His preparation to come out of eternity into time. This was the purpose of creation. Then while the locusts were operating (Joel 1:4; 2:25), Christ came forth. In eternity Christ was concealed in His divinity, but through incarnation He came forth with His divinity into humanity.

Christ's going forth, His appearing, is a continuous matter. From the time of His incarnation, He began to come forth, and His coming forth is still taking place today. Christ's coming forth will be consummated when He throws Antichrist and the false prophet into the lake of fire (Rev. 19:19-20), when Satan is cast into the abyss (Rev. 20:2-3), and when Christ sets up His throne to reign as King (Matt. 25:31, 34, 40). At that time His appearing will be complete. But today He is still on the way.

While Christ is on the way, He is taking care of the scattered Jews. On the one hand, Israel is under God's chastisement; on the other hand, Israel is also under God's shepherding care. This shepherding is His preservation of Israel.

In the restoration Christ will be the Ruler, Shepherd, and peace to His elect, Israel (Micah 5:2-5a). Today, in His goings forth, He is our Ruler, Shepherd, and peace. As our Ruler, He keeps us; as our Shepherd, He nourishes and cherishes us; and as our peace, He controls our environment so that we may enjoy Him.

E. Israel to be invaded by Assyria and saved by Christ

"When Assyria comes into our land / And when he treads in our palaces, / We will raise up against him seven shepherds / And eight princes of men. / And they will waste the land of Assyria with the sword / And the land of Nimrod at its entrances. / And He will save us from Assyria, / When he comes into our land / And when he treads in our border" (vv. 5b-6). These verses reveal that Christ also will save Israel after they are invaded by Assyria. The coming Christ will take the full responsibility to deal with all of human government, represented by Assyria and Nimrod.

The mentioning of Assyria and Nimrod in these verses is a reminder of the beginning of the locusts, a reminder of when and how the locusts were produced. For the Lord to deal with the Assyrians means that He deals with the first group of the locusts, and this indicates that He will go on to deal with all the locusts.

Here we need to consider once again the great human image in Daniel 2, with its head of gold (Babylon), its breast and its arms of silver (Medo-Persia), its abdomen and its thighs of bronze (Greece), its legs of iron (Rome), and its feet partly of iron and partly of clay (vv. 32-33). The smashing of this image by the stone cut out without hands (Christ) begins not with the head but with the feet. According to verse 34, this stone will strike the image at its feet and crush them. Then the iron, the clay, the bronze, the silver, and the gold will be crushed all at once, and the stone will become a great mountain and fill the whole earth (v. 35). The point here is that the smashing of the feet, which signify Antichrist, involves the smashing of the entire image, signifying the destruction of human government from Assyria and Babylon to Rome. It is significant that Micah speaks of Assyria and Nimrod, the founder of Nineveh (the capital of Assyria) and Babel (Gen. 10:8-11). Actually, Assyria equals Rome, and Nimrod equals Antichrist.

Eventually, Israel will be invaded by Antichrist and his armies. Having collected his evil world powers, Antichrist will besiege the city of Jerusalem, with the intention of putting it to an end. At this juncture Christ will come to destroy Antichrist and his armies and to save Israel. At that time, the great image will be crushed by the stone cut out without hands; Assyria, Nimrod, the empires of Babylon, Persia, Greece, and Rome, and Antichrist will be no more; and the entire earth will become the kingdom of God for eternity. Then all of Jehovah's elect will enjoy Him. This is His comfort to Israel, a comfort that is a matter of restoration.

F. The remnant of Jacob to be blessed by Jehovah and victorious among the nations

After Christ deals with all the enemies, the remnant of Jacob will be blessed by Jehovah, and they also will be victorious among the nations. Concerning this, Micah 5:7 and 8 say that the remnant of Jacob will be in the midst of many peoples like dew from Jehovah, like abundant showers, like a lion among the beasts of the forest, and like a young lion among the flocks of sheep. Regarding the remnant of Jacob, the prophet goes on to say, "Your hand will be raised up against your adversaries, / And all your enemies will be cut off" (v. 9). Some may find it hard to believe that the small nation of Israel will be victorious among the nations, but this is clearly prophesied in the Bible.

G. Jehovah's clearing up of the armies, cities, strongholds, witchcraft, idols, and idol worship from Israel and His executing of vengeance upon the nations

Eventually, Jehovah will clear up the armies, cities, strongholds, witchcraft, idols, and idol worship from Israel, and He will execute vengeance in anger and wrath upon the nations, in the day of restoration (vv. 10-15).

Message 3

The Greatness of the Prophets in Their Speaking Concerning Christ

Scripture Reading: Micah 5:2-9; Amos 9:11-15

In this message I would like to give a word on the greatness of the prophets in their speaking concerning Christ. When Micah and the other prophets spoke concerning Christ, they were touching great things. However, when they turned from Christ to their own observations regarding the condition and situation of God's people, they became small.

Seeing Nimrod and Assyria in relation to Christ

In his prophecy concerning Christ, Micah says, "His goings forth are from ancient times, / From the days of eternity" (5:2). Then he goes on to say that this One, who is Israel's Ruler and Shepherd, will be the peace when Assyria comes into the land (v. 5). In verse 6 the prophet first speaks of the land of Assyria and the land of Nimrod, and then, prophesying about Christ, declares, "He will save us from Assyria." In these verses we can see Nimrod and Assyria as they are related to Christ.

Human government began with Nimrod, the first type of Antichrist. According to Genesis 10:10 and 11, Nimrod built the cities of Babel and Nineveh. Babel issued in Babylon, the height of human government (Dan. 2:31-45) and the first stage of the locusts, that is, the cutting locusts (Joel 1:4). Human government, including the empires of Babylon, Persia, Greece, and Rome, has been used by God to carry out His work of the chastisement of Israel. Eventually, the entire human government — the four kinds of locusts mentioned in Joel 1 and the four sections of the great image described in Daniel 2 — will be smashed by a single stone, Christ as the stone cut out without hands that will become a great mountain and fill the whole earth (Dan. 2:34-35). In this way Christ will save Israel from Assyria.

Regarding the four locusts in Joel, the Lord has given us a bright revelation. This enlightenment, this shining, opens not only the Bible but the entire history of the world. Furthermore, this revelation opens up God's eternal economy, for the four stages of the locusts occupy a great part of God's economy in relation to mankind. It may be that before too long the locusts will be destroyed and, as Hosea 6:2 prophesies, dormant Israel will be raised up on the third day.

The prophets turning from Christ to small things

The prophets are great in their speaking about Christ but not in their speaking about other things. We may use Micah and Amos as examples. On the one hand, they both prophesied concerning Christ; on the other hand, they both spoke about such a small thing as deceitful balances. Amos said that the corrupt people made the ephah small and the shekel large and falsified the balances for deceit (8:5). Concerning this, Micah said, "Are there yet treasures of wickedness in the house of the wicked, / And a scant measure that is abominable? / Shall I be pure with wicked balances / And with a bag of deceitful weights?" (6:10-11). Both prophets observed that the people used one measure for buying and a different measure for selling and that their weights and balances were deceitful. The word of Amos and Micah about such a small matter cannot compare with the greatness of their word concerning Christ.

The prophet Joel differs from Micah and Amos in that he did not speak regarding small things. Rather, in just three chapters he spoke concerning five great matters: (1) the four kinds of locusts (1:4); (2) the outpouring of the Spirit (2:28-32); (3) the coming of Christ with all the mighty ones to defeat Antichrist with his armies to change this age (3:11, 13); (4) the judging of all the living nations to separate the "sheep" from the "goats" (3:2, 12; cf. Matt. 25:31-46); and (5) Christ's reigning among Israel in the millennial kingdom (Joel 3:16-17, 21b).

Prophets, not psalmists

In contrast, Amos and Micah used many more chapters than Joel to speak of things other than Christ. When these prophets spoke concerning Christ, they spoke great things, but when they expressed their own natural concept and opinion, they were like some of the psalmists. For instance, Micah 6:8 says, “He has declared to you, O man, what is good; / And what does Jehovah require of you, / But that you would execute justice and love lovingkindness / And walk humbly with your God?” Is this word according to the tree of life or according to the tree of the knowledge of good and evil? Surely it is according to the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. Is this word according to the divine revelation or according to the human concept of the prophet? This word is not a matter of God’s revelation but of the prophet’s concept.

My concern here actually is not with the shortcomings of these prophets but with our situation today. I am concerned that some of us may take the four governing principles, or the four factors, we have seen in the Minor Prophets and use them in a critical way to examine others in the church, especially the elders. Those who do this may be like certain of the psalmists, but they are not prophets speaking for God.

In 1 Corinthians 14 Paul encouraged us to be prophets, not psalmists (vv. 24, 31). If we express our concept or opinion, we are like some of the psalmists. To prophesy is not only to speak for Christ but also to speak forth Christ and even to speak Christ. If we have an opinion or concept, that opinion or concept must be Christ. We should have no heart to express our opinion. Our burden, desire, intention, and goal should be just to speak Christ. I can testify that my aim in all the messages I put out is to speak Christ and Christ alone.

Amos’s and Micah’s greatness in their prophesying concerning Christ

In their prophesying concerning Christ, Amos and Micah are great.

Amos’s prophecy concerning Christ’s rebuilding the fallen tabernacle of David

Amos is great in his prophecy concerning Christ’s rebuilding the fallen tabernacle of David. In Amos 9:11 the prophet says, “In that day I will raise up / The fallen tabernacle of David, / And I will wall up its breaches / And raise up its ruins / And build it up as it was in the days of old.” We have seen that the tabernacle of David is the kingdom of David and the royal family of David. The kingdom of David was a type of the coming kingdom of Christ. When Christ comes back, He will rebuild, that is, restore and recover, the kingdom of His forefather David and fully make the kingdom of David the kingdom of Christ and of God for eternity.

Micah’s prophecy concerning the goings forth of Christ

Micah’s prophecy concerning the goings forth of the all-inclusive Christ is a great matter. In this prophecy Christ is all-inclusive because He will be the Ruler, the Shepherd, and the peace of Israel, and He will also bring forth the seven shepherds and the eight princes (5:2-5).

Christ came forth from Bethlehem, a small town called “David’s city” (Luke 2:4). However, His goings forth were not from time but from eternity. In eternity past He selected us and predestinated us (Eph. 1:4-5). When He was doing these things, He considered how He would come. If He had only selected and predestinated us without preparing to come out of eternity, He could do nothing with us. Whatever He will do and can do for us depends on His coming forth. He came in incarnation, and He went on through human living, death, resurrection, ascension, and the outpouring of the consummated Spirit, who is the reality of Christ Himself. All these are great steps in Christ’s going forth. His going forth has not stopped but is continuing today.

Jehovah's Contending with Israel and the Prophet's Observation and Expectation

Scripture Reading: Micah 6; Micah 7

In chapter five Micah reaches the high peak of his prophecy concerning Christ. Then in chapters six and seven, which we will cover in this message, he descends to a much lower plain. His prophecy in chapter five is great, but his prophecy in chapters six and seven is not great but is very much according to the human concept.

IV. Jehovah's contending with Israel

Micah 6 is a record of Jehovah's contending with Israel. Because contending is a matter of fighting by speaking, it is not pleasant for anyone involved.

A. Taking Israel's history as a base

In His contending with Israel, Jehovah took Israel's history, from the time of the exodus, as a base (vv. 1-5). Verse 2b declares that Jehovah has a contention with His people and that He will dispute with Israel. Then He asks them to remember what He did for them in bringing them out of Egypt. "For I brought you up out of the land of Egypt, / And from the slave house I redeemed you; / And I sent before you Moses, / Aaron, and Miriam. / O My people, remember now what Balak king of Moab counseled, / And what Balaam the son of Beor answered him, / From Shittim to Gilgal, / That you may know the righteous acts of Jehovah" (vv. 4-5).

B. Aspiring after Israel's genuine worship and sincere service

Verses 6 through 8 reveal that Jehovah aspired after Israel's genuine worship and sincere service. Israel had been busy in the worship of God for centuries, but their worship was not genuine. Much of what they offered was not offered to God but either to themselves or to their idols. Thus, in verse 6 the prophet asks with what he should come before Jehovah, saying, "Shall I come before Him with burnt offerings, / With one-year-old calves?" In verse 7 he asks if Jehovah would be pleased with thousands of rams or with ten thousands of rivers of oil, and then he says, "Shall I give my firstborn for my transgression, / The fruit of my body for the sin of my soul?" God would never require anyone to offer their children as a sacrifice, but the people of Israel actually did this in order to fulfill the requirements of their idols. Only idol worshippers would make sacrifices of their children. Here Jehovah was contending with Israel concerning their idol worship and their offering sacrifices to idols. For this reason, in verse 8 Micah prophesies, saying, "He has declared to you, O man, what is good; / And what does Jehovah require of you, / But that you would execute justice and love lovingkindness / And walk humbly with your God?"

C. Stating the cause and the effect

In verses 9 through 16 we have the stating of the cause and the effect. The cause is Israel's sins, and the effect is Jehovah's punishment.

V. The prophet's observation and expectation

Chapter seven speaks of the prophet Micah's observation and expectation. His observation involved a close study and examination of the condition and situation of God's people. His expectation was related to his attempt to find something with which he could encourage himself. Much of what he says in this chapter is an expression of his natural sentiment.

A. The prophet's observation of discouragement

First, the prophet observed the condition and situation of God's chosen people and became fully discouraged (vv. 1-6). In his discouragement he said, "Woe is me! For I am like a gathering of summer fruit / And like a gleaning of the vintage; / There is no cluster to eat, / Nor first-ripe fig, which my soul desires. / The godly man has perished from the land, / And there is none upright among men; / They all lie in wait for bloodshed; / They each hunt their brother with a net" (vv. 1-2).

In Micah's observation of discouragement there is a lesson for us today. From Micah's experience we should learn not to look at ourselves. If we look at ourselves just a little, we will be discouraged.

B. The prophet's expectation of encouragement

In verses 7 through 20 we have the prophet's expectation of encouragement. Actually, this was a matter of self-comforting. Micah wrote the things found in these verses in order to comfort himself. Thus, they were Micah's self-comforting.

1. Taking the lead to look for Jehovah and wait for God

After observing the poor situation of the people of Israel, the prophet took the lead to look for Jehovah and wait for God (vv. 7-10). Although the condition and situation of God's people caused Micah to be discouraged, he could still say, "But as for me, I will look for Jehovah; / I will wait for the God of my salvation; / My God will hear me" (v. 7).

2. Assuring Israel of her restoration

In verses 11 through 13 Micah assured Israel of her restoration. First, he said that there will be a day for the building of Israel's walls (v. 11a). Then he went on to assure Israel, saying, "In that day they will come even unto you / From Assyria and from the cities of Egypt, / And from Egypt even to the River, / And from sea to sea and mountain to mountain" (v. 12).

3. Asking Jehovah to feed His people Israel

In verses 14 through 17 the prophet asks Jehovah to feed His people Israel.

4. Thanking God for His forgiveness of the remnant of the people

The prophet concludes by thanking God for His forgiveness of the remnant of the people (vv. 18-20). Micah could not praise God that the condition and situation of His people were wonderful, for they had nothing that He could appreciate. Instead, the prophet said, "Who is a God like You, / Pardoning iniquity / And passing over the transgression / Of the remnant of His inheritance? / He does not retain His anger forever, / For He delights in lovingkindness" (v. 18). Here Micah seemed to be saying, "O God, all we have is sin and iniquity. We do not have anything to give to You. But You are a God who pardons our iniquity. There is no God like You. You are also very particular in that You do not retain Your anger forever but delight in lovingkindness." Micah's praise here is centered not on the virtues of God's elect people but on God's attributes. Such a praise is very comforting.

In verse 19 the prophet continues, "He will again have compassion on us; / He will tread our iniquities underfoot. / And You will cast into the depths of the sea / All their sins." Once again, Micah confesses that the people have many iniquities but that God is a forgiving God and will tread their iniquities under foot and cast their sins into the depths of the sea.

Finally, Micah says, "You will perform truth to Jacob, / And lovingkindness to Abraham, / Which You have sworn to our fathers / From the days of old" (v. 20). Here we see Micah's hope and expectation.

In a sense, Micah's word in chapters six and seven is good, but it cannot compare with his revelation concerning Christ in chapter five.